Cybercrime Case Study: UPI Payment Fraud

UPI payment fraud is a common cybercrime in India where fraudsters trick users into sending money through fake requests or links. This type of fraud usually happens when the attacker contacts the victim through a phone call, message, or social media, pretending to be a bank official, delivery agent, or customer support.

The process typically begins with the scammer gaining the victim's trust. They may claim that the user has won a prize, needs to receive money, or must update their KYC details. The victim is then asked to click on a link or approve a UPI request. Instead of receiving money, the victim unknowingly authorizes a payment from their account. In some cases, scammers also ask for OTPs or screen-sharing access to steal sensitive information.

Students and elderly people are common targets because they may not be fully aware of such scams. The consequences can be serious, including financial loss, stress, and loss of trust in digital systems.

This case highlights the importance of awareness and caution while using digital payment platforms. Users must always verify requests and avoid sharing personal or financial information with unknown sources.